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Spear, lance

2.5 Spear, lance

References:

Hebrew חֲנִית (chanith) [1SA 13:19](#), [1SA 13:22](#), [1SA 17:7](#), [1SA 17:7](#), [1SA 17:45](#), [1SA 17:47](#), [1SA 18:10](#), [1SA 18:11](#), [1SA 19:9](#), [1SA 19:10](#), [1SA 19:10](#), [1SA 20:33](#), [1SA 21:9](#), [1SA 22:6](#), [1SA 26:8](#), [1SA 26:12](#), [1SA 26:16](#), [1SA 26:22](#), [1SA 26:22](#), [2SA 1:6](#), [2SA 2:23](#), [2SA 2:23](#), [2SA 21:19](#), [2SA 23:7](#), [2SA 23:18](#), [2SA 23:21](#), [2SA 23:21](#), [2SA 23:21](#), [2KI 11:10](#), [1CH 11:11](#), [1CH 11:20](#), [1CH 11:23](#), [1CH 11:23](#), [1CH 11:23](#), [1CH 12:35](#), [1CH 20:5](#), [2CH 23:9](#), [JOB 39:23](#), [JOB 41:18](#), [PSA 35:3](#), [PSA 46:10](#), [PSA 57:5](#), [ISA 2:4](#), [MIC 4:3](#), [NAM 3:3](#), [HAB 3:11](#)

Hebrew רֶמֶח (romach) [NUM 25:7](#), [JDG 5:8](#), [1KI 18:28](#), [1CH 12:9](#), [1CH 12:25](#), [2CH 11:12](#), [2CH 14:7](#), [2CH 25:5](#), [2CH 26:14](#), [NEH 4:7](#), [NEH 4:10](#), [NEH 4:15](#), [JER 46:4](#), [EZE 39:9](#), [JOL 4:10](#)

Hebrew שֶׁטֶף (shevet) [2SA 18:14](#)

Greek γαῖσος (gaisos) [JDT 9:7](#)

Greek δεξιολάβος (dexiolabos) [ACT 23:23](#)

Greek δόρα, δόρυ (dora, doru) [JDT 7:10](#), [JDT 11:2](#), [ESG 8:12](#), [SIR 29:13](#), [3MA 3:15](#), [3MA 5:43](#), [3MA 6:5](#)

Greek κάμαξ (kamax) [2MA 5:3](#)

Greek κέντρον (kentron) [4MA 14:19](#)

Greek λόγχη (logchē) [JHN 19:34](#), [2MA 5:2](#), [2MA 15:11](#)

Greek σιβύνη (sibunē (zibunē)) [JDT 1:15](#)

Latin framea [2ES 13:9](#), [2ES 13:28](#)

Description:

The spear was a long, straight rod with a sharp end used for piercing by thrusting. Its circumference was less than the grip of a man's hand, and its length varied from the height of a man to much longer. It was normally made of wood with a metal head or point (see [2.5.1 Spearhead<REALIA:2.5.1>](#)). The butt of the spear was also covered with a pointed piece of metal (see [2SA 2:23](#)) and was used to stick the spear in the ground or to drive oxen or horses as a goad.

See the illustration at [2.3.1 Sheath, scabbard<REALIA:2.3.1>](#).

Usage:

In battle the spear was held in the middle and thrust at the enemy. Only rarely was it intended for throwing (see [2.6 Javelin<REALIA:2.6>](#)).

Translation:

Where possible, translators should choose a word or phrase that indicates that this weapon was held and thrust (much like a knife on the end of a stick) rather than thrown.

The phrase “lifted up his spear” occurs in [2SA 23:18](#) and [1CH 11:11](#). GNT gives the correct meaning with “fought with his spear.”

The meaning of the Greek word *dexiolabos* in [ACT 23:23](#) is uncertain. Most translations have “spearmen” (RSV, NIV), “foot soldiers with spears” (CEV), “men with spears” (NCV), or “light-armed troops” (REB).

Spearhead

2.5.1 Spearhead

References:

Hebrew לְהָבָה (lehavah) [1SA 17:7](#)

Hebrew קַיִן (qayin) [2SA 21:16](#)

Description and usage:



Bronze spearhead from Iran, Luristan, ca 1000–550 BCE (Los Angeles County Museum of Art www.lacma.org, Public domain, via Wikimedia Commons) The spearhead was a piece of metal, usually iron or bronze, attached to the end of the spear (see [2.5 Spear, lance<REALIA:2.5>](#)). It was either placed over the end of the spear shaft like a sleeve or wedged into a split at the end of the spear shaft and secured by tying it with a cord. The spearhead was sharpened to a point.

Translation:

In both of the references the spearhead is mentioned because of its exceptional size (about 7 kilograms, 15–16 pounds). The spearhead of an average soldier weighed much less. It is possible, but less likely, that the Hebrew word *qayin* in [2SA 21:16](#) refers to the entire spear, including its iron head.